

Games & Fun Pack • The Hackles Trail

Games and Fun

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY

1

hackles up!



Hackle

whose quills stand up when something feels off

2



Latch

LOCK IT

3



Peeper

SPOT IT

4



Pip

SHARE SMART

5



Buddy

SAFE PEOPLE

6



Ember

KIND AND WELL

7



Fixit

FIX IT

PLATE I. The Hackles crew, drawn from life: Hackle (1) and the six friends who look after each strand.

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[Logo: Hackles]

THE HACKLES TRAIL

A cooperative whole-class board game: the Crew versus the Too-Good Box

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

Teacher Quick Start (one page, print and keep)

What it is: a whole-class board game. The class moves one Crew Token from Home Hollow to Hackles Peak by answering "what would you do?" cards. A silly gold box named Gifty tries to tempt you every few turns. The class always reaches the Peak.

You need: the board (poster paper or floor tape), 1 Crew Token, a clear cup (the **Glitter Jar**) with 2 pom-poms beside it, a **Gifty Coin** (any coin, one side marked with a hook), a Class Ladder strip (3 rungs), 10 Rung Tokens, 3 answer cards per team (circle A, triangle B, square C), the card piles, a timer.

MOMENT	WHAT YOU DO
Setup (3 min)	Make 4 to 6 teams. Put the token on START, the jar empty. Shuffle each pile face down. Read the story. Say: " A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault. "
A team turn (about 1.4 min)	1) Read the top Event card for the zone the token is in (twice, slowly, with the A/B/C choices). 2) Every team whispers for 20 seconds. 3) Say " Peek! " and all teams show A, B or C at once. 4) The active team's card decides the move: Best = 5 spaces, OK = 4, Oops-path = 3 . Nobody ever moves backward for an answer. 5) Read the reasons for all three choices as a story. Everyone says "Nice noticing!" 6) Do the space you land on (see the legend). 7) Next team.
Gifty's turn	After every third team turn, and whenever the token lands on a G space: read a Lure card in Gifty's voice. The whole class holds up the Pause Palm and names the flag ("P for Pressure!"). Then flip the Gifty Coin : hook side = a Glitter Slip (a trick sometimes gets through, even when everyone does everything right): add 1 pom-pom to the jar, Crew slips back 2 spaces (the first slip is free), draw a Fixit card. Plain side = Gifty is beaten: cheer.
Sparkle Storm	When the jar holds 2 pom-poms it overflows. Everyone stands, jazz hands, then each team says one Help Ladder sentence (the Ladder Rescue). Empty the jar. The class earns a Rescue Ribbon.
Ending	The token reaches or passes space 40: Hackles Peak . Do the Big Pause. Gold = 0 Storms, Silver = 1, Bronze = 2 or more. Every tier gets the same cheer and certificate.

Time check: Full Trail is about 30 minutes (9 team turns, 3 Gifty turns, 2 Ladder scenes). **Sunrise Wind rule:** if the token is not past space 32 when 24 minutes have gone, say "A friendly wind lifts the Crew up the Peak Path!", move the token to space 36, play the last event, and finish. **Mini Trail** is about 10 minutes (15 spaces).

Say, not "wrong": "Fixit's Oops Path." Never say "wrong" or "you lost".

If...

- **A team wants to pass:** "Pass to the Guides": the other teams' majority answer decides and counts as OK.

- **A child looks scared of Gifty:** stop, say "Gifty is a silly box with a hook," show the Gifty prop, make a funny noise.
- **A child shares something real:** thank them, follow your disclosure box, do not promise secrecy.
- **A card does not fit your class:** remove it (H cards for opted-out classes) and draw another.

Never: let a child play Gifty, name real students on cards, or let a team be blamed for the class's score.

1 At a glance

SPECIMEN LABEL	
PLAYERS	A whole class (up to 30) in 4 to 6 Crew Teams. Also plays with a small group of 3 to 6 at a table.
TIME	10-minute "Mini Trail" (about 10 minutes) or 30-minute "Full Trail" (about 28 to 30 minutes; the Sunrise Wind rule guarantees you finish). An optional 45-minute "Epic Trail" can be split over two days.
AGES	K-12. One board, four card sets: K-2 (read-aloud), 3-5, 6-8, 9-12.
STYLE	100 percent cooperative. One shared Crew Token climbs from Home Hollow to Hackles Peak. The class plays <i>against a silly trickster, not against each other</i> . The class cannot lose; it earns a Gold, Silver or Bronze Peak (all three are celebrated).
NEEDS	A board (poster paper or floor tape), 1 Crew Token, a Glitter Jar (clear cup + 2 pom-poms), a Gifty Coin, a Class Ladder strip, Rung Tokens, 3 answer cards per team, printed cards, timer
STRANDS	All six: Lock It, Spot It, Share Smart, Safe People, Kind & Well, Fix It

THE LEARNING GOAL

Players will **practice the Hackles routine (Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.) in many different situations, practice saying the Tell sentence out loud and climbing the Help Ladder** (including the **Next-Rung Rule**: if the first person does not help, climb to the next rung), and **learn that recovering from a mistake is a normal, shame-free part of the journey**. In grades 6-12 they also practice STOP, SAVE, TELL, REPORT and "second channel" checking.

LESSONS THIS GAME REINFORCES

BAND	LESSONS
K-2	L1 My Tell-Someone Team; L2 Secret Passwords; L3 Pause and Ask; L4 The Oops Button; L6 Online Friends vs. Real Friends
3-5	L1 The Help Ladder; L2 Passphrase Lab; L3 Scam Spotters; L6 Game Chat Red Flags; L10 Oops Recovery
6-8	L1 Help Ladder: Real Practice (Next-Rung Rule); L2 Account Defense; L3 Phish Lab; L7 Response Drill (optional (H) events); L9 Group Chat Dynamics
9-12	L1 Threat-Model Yourself; L2 Credentials and Passkeys; L3 Social Engineering Case Lab; L8 Be the Helper; L10 Capstone

THE STORY (READ THIS ALOUD FIRST)

Field note

No. 1

Teacher (K-5): "The Hackles Crew is going on a hike to the top of Hackles Peak! Latch has the locks. Peeper has the magnifying glass. Pip has the privacy shell. Buddy has the trusted hand. Ember has the warm glow. Fixit has the toolbelt. And Hackle has the quills that stand up when something feels off.

But wait. Do you see that shiny gold box on the path, with the sparkly bow and a teeny hook peeking out? That is the **Too-Good Box**. Everyone calls him **Gifty**. Gifty LOVES to offer you things that are too good to be true. 'Free coins! Free ponies! Free everything! Just tap and keep it a secret!' He is not scary. He is just very, very silly, and he wants to be your friend. But we know the trick. Everything Gifty offers has a hook!

Your job: get the whole Crew to the top of Hackles Peak. Every time something feels off, Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell. Ready to hike?"

Field note

No. 2

Teacher (6-12): "This is a cooperative game. You are a team of hikers working through situations you might meet. Gifty, the Too-Good-To-Be-True offer, shows up now and then. He is a symbol, not a person. He is not scary. He is just persistent. We will use Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell, plus the Help Ladder, and you will decide as a class what to do. You cannot lose. You can only earn a Bronze, Silver or Gold Peak depending on how many times the glitter storm hits us."

2 Components

2.1 THE BOARD (BUILD IT IN 15 MINUTES)

Build: Use 4 sheets of poster paper taped together, or tape a path on the floor. Draw 40 circles in a winding path divided into 8 zones. Color each zone with its Crew color. Put a big gold star at the end (Hackles Peak). Add decorations: Latch's pine trees, Peeper's pond with a hook-fish, Pip's meadow with shells, Buddy's forest with a heart-shaped trail sign, Ember's glowing cove, Fixit's bridge with a toolbelt, Hackles Peak with a big quill flag. (See the Art Style Guide: thick outlines, flat bright colors, big shapes, no scary imagery.)

The Trail Map (grid). Read the grid from space 1 at the bottom-left and follow the arrows (snake-like) to space 40 at the top. Each row is one zone. (Row 1 is drawn at the bottom of your poster.)

ZONE (CREW GUIDE)	SPACE A	SPACE B	SPACE C	SPACE D	SPACE E
8. Hackles Peak (Hackle + all)	40 FINISH (star)	39 B	38 L	37 H	36 E
7. Fix-It Bridge (Fixit)	31 E	32 L	33 E	34 L	35 G
6. Kind Cove (Ember)	30 E	29 B	28 E	27 H	26 E
5. Friend Forest (Buddy)	21 E	22 L	23 E	24 L	25 G
4. Share Meadow (Pip)	20 B	19 E	18 L	17 E	16 E
3. Fishy Pond (Peeper)	11 E	12 L	13 E	14 H	15 G
2. Password Pines (Latch)	10 G	9 E	8 B	7 E	6 E
1. Home Hollow (Hackle)	1 E	2 E	3 H	4 E	5 L

How to read the map: the trail is a snake. Zone 1 runs left to right (spaces 1 to 5) along the bottom of your poster. Zone 2 turns around and runs right to left (6 to 10), Zone 3 runs left to right again (11 to 15), and so on up to Hackles Peak at the top. The table lists Peak first because it is drawn at the top. **Start** is a sign just before space 1 ("START: Hackle's House").

Space legend

CODE	NAME	WHAT HAPPENS
E	Trail space	A calm place to stand. The Event card for this turn has already been played, so nothing else happens except a 5-second Hackles Up signal from the whole class. (Spaces 1 and 2 are the doorstep: a normal move never lands there, so decorate them.)

CODE	NAME	WHAT HAPPENS
L	Ladder	Draw a Ladder Scenario card. The class climbs the Help Ladder (see Section 4) and says the sentence aloud. Fills one rung on the Class Ladder strip and earns 1 Rung Token .
H	Helper	Draw a Helper card (a Crew boost).
B	Breathe	The whole class does a 10-second Pause: three slow breaths, then Hackles Up, Pause, Check, Tell. Take 1 pom-pom out of the Glitter Jar (if there is one).
G	Gifty's Gift Stop	A Gifty turn (see Rules).
FINISH	Hackles Peak	Triumph! Do the Big Pause chant.

Space count: 19 Trail (E), 8 Ladder (L), 4 Helper (H), 4 Breathe (B), 4 Gifty's Gift Stop (G), 1 Finish = 40. (*Playtest note: with 5 Ladder spaces the Class Ladder almost never filled, so there are now 8. In 1,000 simulated games the token lands on about 2 Ladder spaces per game.*) Tip: add more B spaces for an energetic class, more L spaces to emphasize Tell.

2.2 OTHER PIECES

PIECE	WHAT IT IS
Crew Token	One shared token: a cut-out of Hackle on a clothespin, a wooden meeples, a yellow pom-pom with strands of orange yarn for quills. The whole class moves it.
Team tent cards	4 to 6 folded cards with a Crew name, used to show whose turn it is.
Answer cards (3 per team)	A = circle, B = triangle, C = square , each with a big letter and a different notched corner. Never use color alone. (K-2: hand signals instead.)
Glitter Jar	A clear cup with room for 2 gold pom-poms (or paper "glitter"). When a second pom-pom goes in, the jar overflows: Sparkle Storm.
Gifty Coin	Any coin or a paper disc: one side has a tiny hook ("Glitter Slip"), the other a plain star ("Gifty is beaten").
Class Ladder strip	A drawn ladder with 3 climbing rungs: 2 A friend, 3 A trusted adult, 4 A reporting channel , standing on the ground, 1 You (Pause) . Each L space fills one rung. K-2: three big steps with pictures.
Rung Tokens	10 paper "rungs" or craft sticks in a basket. Earned from L spaces and Best Tell choices. Spent to cancel a Detour or give +1 step (see Section 3).
Trail Event cards	24 for K-5, 24 for 6-12 (Section 7).
Gifty Lure cards	8 for K-5, 8 for 6-12 (Section 8).
Ladder Scenario cards	8 for K-5, 8 for 6-12 (Section 9).
Helper cards	10 (Section 10).
Fixit cards ("Oops Is Okay")	8 (Section 11).
Pass cards	Green, with the word PASS and a check mark.
Timer	Optional.

3 Rules

SETUP

1. Divide the class into 4 to 6 **Crew Teams**. Teams pick a Crew name (Latch Locks, Peeper Pals, Pip Pods, Buddy Bunch, Ember Krew, Fixit Fixers, or a name the team invents) and write it on a tent card. Hand each team its A, B and C answer cards.
2. Place the Crew Token on START. Put the Glitter Jar (empty) and the Gifty Coin by the board. Put the Class Ladder where all can see it. Put the Rung Tokens in a "Rung Basket."
3. Shuffle each card set into its own pile: Events (sort by zone: 3 cards per zone), Lures, Ladder Scenarios, Helpers, Fixit. Place face down.
4. Read the story. Say the two promises: **"A false alarm is fine. It is never your fault."**
5. The teacher is the **Reader** and does Gifty's voice. Later, a student volunteer may read (never forced).

A TURN (ABOUT 1.4 MINUTES)

1. **Draw and read.** The Reader draws the top Event card for the zone the token is in (any card if that zone's three cards are used up) and reads it aloud **twice**, slowly, saying "A, circle... B, triangle... C, square...".
2. **Everyone whispers.** *Every* team huddles for 20 seconds and chooses A, B or C, and the active team also says which Hackles step it used (Hackles up? Pause? Check? Tell?). No shouting out. (This is what stops 4 teams from waiting while 1 plays.)
3. **Peek!** On "Peek!" all teams hold up A, B or C at the same moment.
4. **The active team's card decides the move** (the team whose turn it is, rotating clockwise). The other teams are the **Trail Guides**: their cards are practice, and the Reader says "Guides, who spotted it?" with a cheer for every correct Guide.
5. **Reveal.** The Reader reads the **Best, OK** and **Oops-path** results *as a short story about all three choices*, never "you were wrong". Then the Crew Token moves:

- **Best choice: move 5 spaces.** Also take one Rung Token if the best choice was a Tell.
 - **OK choice: move 4 spaces.**
 - **Oops-path choice: move 3 spaces** and draw a **Fixit card** ("Oops Is Okay"). Everyone is fine. The Fixit card is a gift.
 - **Pass to the Guides:** a team may say "Pass to the Guides." The Guides' most common card decides, and it counts as an OK move (4). No questions asked.
- 6. Land.** If the token lands on a special space (L, H, B, G), do its action.
E spaces: one quick Hackles Up signal and nothing else.
- 7. Rotate** to the next team.

Field note

No. 3

The rule that makes this safe: *Nobody moves backward for an answer.* An Oops-path choice still moves forward. The only way the Crew slips back is a *Glitter Slip* (below), and that happens to the whole class by the flip of a coin, never because of one team.

GIFTY'S TURN (AFTER EVERY THIRD TEAM TURN, AND WHEN THE TOKEN LANDS ON A G SPACE)

- 1. The Reader draws a Gifty Lure card** and does Gifty's voice (see Section 8). (6-12: reads the "Today's Too-Good Offer" card in a plain voice.)
- 2. The class always resists.** Everyone shows the Pause Palm and says "Hackles up!" and names the flag ("S for Secret!" / FLAGS). 6-12: name two flags and a second channel.
- 3. Flip the Gifty Coin.**
 - **Plain star side: Gifty is beaten.** Cheer. Nothing else happens.
 - **Hook side: a Glitter Slip.** *Even when everyone does everything right, a clever trick can sometimes get through. That is true in real life, and it is never anyone's fault.* Put **1 pom-pom in the Glitter Jar**. The Crew Token takes a **Detour: back 2 spaces** ("slipped on glitter"), except that **the first Glitter Slip of the game is free (no Detour)**. Draw a **Fixit card**.

4. **Undo a Detour.** The class may spend **one Rung Token** and say a Tell sentence aloud to cancel a Detour ("Fixit says: we told someone, and the glitter was swept away!").

(Why a coin and not a class vote? In the first draft the class "voted" to be fooled or not, and every class simply resisted every time: in 1,000 simulated games Gold Peak happened 999 times, so the Glitter Meter, Detours and Fixit cards never mattered. A tempted child could also choose "Tap" on purpose for fun. The coin gives the Storm a real chance and teaches a true lesson: tricks sometimes get through, so we have a Ladder.)

RUNG TOKENS (WHAT THEY DO)

SPEND	EFFECT
1 Rung Token	Cancel a Detour.
1 Rung Token	Add +1 step to a move.

Next-Rung Rule on the board: Rung Tokens are earned on L spaces by saying the *next* rung when the first fails (see Section 9).

THE GLITTER JAR AND THE SPARKLE STORM

The Glitter Jar holds 2 pom-poms. When the second one goes in, the jar overflows and Gifty throws a **Sparkle Storm**: a silly glitter blizzard. The whole class stands, does jazz hands, and then does the **Ladder Rescue**: each Crew Team says one Help Ladder sentence aloud (a friend, a trusted adult, a report). Empty the jar. The token does not move back. **The class earns a Rescue Ribbon.** Rescue Ribbons count for scoring. They are not shameful. They show the class used the Ladder. B spaces, the Hackle's Quills Helper and the Wild Pause Helper each take 1 pom-pom out of the jar.

THE CLASS LADDER

Each L space asks the class to climb a rung (friend, trusted adult, reporting channel) and say the sentence. When all **3 rungs** are filled, the class earns a **Ladder Wish**: choose one: (1) empty the Glitter Jar, (2) skip ahead 3 spaces, (3) draw 2 Helper cards. Then clear the strip for another go.

WINNING: THE PEAK TIERS

When the Crew Token lands on or passes space 40, the class reaches **Hackles Peak**. All tiers are wins.

TIER	CONDITION	HOW OFTEN (1,000 SIMULATED FULL TRAILS)
Gold Peak	0 Sparkle Storms	about 7 games in 10
Silver Peak	1 Sparkle Storm	about 3 games in 10
Bronze Peak	2 or more Sparkle Storms	about 1 game in 100

Every tier earns the same certificate ("Hackles Trail Crew") and the same cheer. Say: **"A Rescue Ribbon means you climbed the Ladder. That is exactly the point."** The tier mostly measures how the coin fell, not how well the class played, so never praise or scold the class for its tier.

SUNRISE WIND (KEEPS YOU ON TIME)

If the token is not past space 32 when 24 minutes of play have gone, the Reader says "A friendly wind lifts the Crew up the Peak Path!" and moves the token to space 36. Play one last Event, then finish.

THE BIG PAUSE (END-OF-GAME RITUAL, 1 MINUTE)

1. Everyone does the Hackles Up signal (spikes!).
2. Everyone does the Pause Palm and takes a slow breath.
3. Everyone does Check Eyes.
4. Everyone does the Tell Wave.
5. The Reader (as Gifty) gives a grumpy-then-giggly speech. Examples:
"Fine, fine, you win. But I'd like it noted that my gift was *very* shiny."
"I just wanted to give you something... with a hook. Okay, that's not a good plan." "Honestly? The best present is 'Ask a trusted adult.' I'm going to go put on a party hat."
6. Team announcements: each team says one thing they will remember.

4 The Help Ladder on the Trail (the heart of the game)

The Help Ladder in this kit: **Rung 1: You (Pause)**. **Rung 2: A friend who can come with you**. **Rung 3: A trusted adult** (parent or caregiver, relative, teacher, counselor, coach, nurse). **Rung 4: A reporting channel** (the platform's report tool, school staff, a helpline, NCMEC CyberTipline for serious cases [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: report.cybertip.org]). **The Next-Rung Rule:** if the first person you tell does not help, you are not done. Keep climbing until someone helps.

- **K-2:** teach "Trusted Hand" (five fingers = up to five trusted grown-ups; some children will have fewer, and that is fine) and only use Rung 3. Ladder cards for K-2 say: "Tell a trusted grown-up" and the sentence starter.
- **3-5:** teach the three climbing rungs (friend, trusted adult, report). The Trail adds "Rung 1: Pause" as the ground. Use the 3-5 sentence starters: "I need help with something online." "Something happened and I'm not sure what to do." "I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."
- **6-8:** teach all four rungs and the Tell-3 script.
- **9-12:** the 9-12 Teacher Guide teaches three rungs (friend, trusted adult, formal report) with Pause as the ground; the Trail treats that as the four-rung strip. Teens can start at any rung and may skip up a rung.
- **Numbering note (rung numbers differ by guide).** The Trail numbers the rungs 1 You (Pause), 2 Friend, 3 Trusted adult, 4 Report. The 3-5 and 9-12 guides count only the climbing rungs (1 Friend, 2 Trusted adult, 3 Report); the 6-8 guide matches the Trail. When you play with a 3-5 or 9-12 class, **say the rung by name, not by number** ("tell a trusted adult"), so nobody is confused. See the Help Ladder entry in [11_Teacher_Academy/Academy_Glossary.md](#).

Good-grown-up reply (the Listener's line when practicing): "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's figure it out together."

5 Gifty: how he works (never scary)

- **Gifty is a cardboard (or drawn) gold box with a sparkly bow and a tiny hook.** He is not alive in the scary sense. He is a *symbol* of every offer that is too good to be true. In the games he is always silly, a little bit vain, and defeated by a calm pause. He is a box with a hook, not a sad stranger who just needs a friend: real tricky messages are never sorry, so we always Pause.
- **The teacher plays Gifty** in a goofy voice (a game-show host with a cold, a dramatic opera singer, a very polite pirate). Students do **not** play Gifty; nobody practices tricking.
- **Gifty never takes anything away from the class.** The worst he can do is make the Crew slip on glitter (a Glitter Slip), and the Crew always gets up again.
- **Gifty is always beaten by a Pause.** Make sure the class knows Gifty's catchphrase: **"Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. Aw, shucks!"**
- **For 6-12:** Gifty appears as a small icon on cards labeled "Today's Too-Good Offer." No voices. The class names flags with the **FLAGS** list.

SOME GIFTY LINES THE TEACHER CAN USE (MIX AND MATCH)

- "Hello, friend! I have a free thing! It's free! Totally free! (It has a hook. A very small hook.)"
- "I would never trick you. I'm a gift box. I'm wrapped!"
- "Only 3 seconds left! 3... 2... 2.5... Okay, take your time."
- "I'm not saying you're special. I'm saying you're EXTRA special. Give me your password."
- "Everybody wins! Everybody who gives me their address. Well, 'wins' is a strong word."
- "Don't tell your grown-up. They will want a share of my prize. (They won't. There isn't one. Hmm.)"
- "Aw, shucks. You Paused. Again."

6 10-minute "Mini Trail" and 30-minute "Full Trail"

10-MINUTE MINI TRAIL (A WARM-UP, STATION OR RECESS GAME)

1. Use **three zones only: Fishy Pond (11-15), Share Meadow (16-20), Fix-It Bridge (31-35)**. Lay them end to end as a 15-space trail. **START** is before 11 and **FINISH** is after 35. Treat the H space (14) as a **B** (Breathe) space, because Helper cards are skipped.
2. Pull **6 Events** (any three zones), **3 Lures**, **2 Ladder Scenarios**. Skip Helper cards.
3. The Glitter Jar holds 2 pom-poms. **Gifty's turn after every second team turn**. Moves are the same as the Full Trail (Best 5, OK 4, Oops-path 3).
4. Tell the story in 3 sentences. About 4 team turns, 2 Gifty turns and 1 Ladder scene (1,000 simulated games: about 4 turns; about 9 minutes of play plus a 1-minute Big Pause).
5. Peak Tiers: Gold 0 Storms, Silver 1. (In simulation about 94 games in 100 are Gold.)
6. End with the Big Pause.

30-MINUTE FULL TRAIL

Use the full board, 40 spaces, all card types. Expect about **9 team turns, 3 Gifty turns, 2 Ladder scenes** (1,000 simulated games: mean 9 team turns, finishing in 26 to 33 minutes with an 8-minute story and ritual; the Sunrise Wind rule trims the long tail). Budget:

MINUTES	WHAT
0 to 4	Story, promises, teams, Hackles routine practice
4 to 26	Play (about 1.4 minutes per team turn, 1 minute per Gifty turn, 2 minutes per Ladder scene)
24	Sunrise Wind check
26 to 30	Big Pause, Peak tier, team shout-outs

45-MINUTE EPIC TRAIL (OPTIONAL)

Play the full trail, then continue to the **Peak Challenge**: each team gets one "Bonus Peak Question" from Hackles Peak (any E card unused) and the class creates a 3-line **Crew Promise** ("We promise to Pause, to Check, to Tell, and to be kind about mistakes").

7 Trail Event cards

Each card reads: **Situation. A, B, C. Best, OK, Oops-path (and why).** (The Oops-path is the choice that leads to Fixit's help; the Reader never calls it "wrong".) A teacher may print them as cards or read directly from this list. Option letters are spread out so the best answer is not always B (Best answers are about one third each A, B and C in each deck; the first draft had B as the best answer in 16 of 24 K-5 cards and 23 of 24 6-12 cards, which a skeptical player spots in about two cards). Also watch the length: the Best answer is often the longest, so read all three options in the same voice and speed.

7A. K-5 EVENT CARDS (24: 3 PER ZONE)

Zone 1: Home Hollow (Hackles up and trusted adults)

E1. Maya is playing a game on the family tablet. A pop-up says "WIN A PONY! TAP NOW!" Her dad is cooking in the kitchen. What does Maya do?

A) Tap it to see. B) Close the tablet and say nothing. C) Hackles up! Pause Palm, then walk to Dad and tell.

Best: C (Pause, Tell). **OK: B** (safe, but Dad does not know, so he cannot help). **Oops-path: A** (a prize with a countdown is a trick; next time, Pause first).

E2. Omar's cousin says, "Log in to the family game for me. Just type the password." What does Omar do?

A) Say "Hackles up! Let me ask Teta first." B) Type it, it's only for a minute. C) Pretend he did not hear.

Best: A. OK: C. Oops-path: B (passwords are not for sharing around).

E3. Lily gets a tingly feeling about a message but is not sure it means anything.

A) Do nothing, it might be nothing. B) Reply to the message and ask what it wants. C) Do the Hackles Up signal and tell Rosa anyway. A false alarm is fine!

Best: C. OK: A (no harm but a missed Tell). **Oops-path: B** (replying can keep the trick going; use Pause and Tell).

Zone 2: Password Pines (Latch)

E4. Dev needs a new password for his drawing app.

A) A silly three-word password like "purple-banana-trumpet". B) "Dev123". C) His birthday.

Best: A (long and silly). **OK: B** (easy to guess). **Oops-path: C** (birthdays are easy to find).

E5. A friend says, "Tell me your password and we'll be best friends forever."

A) Share it. B) Say, "Passwords are just for me and my grown-up. Let's play a game instead!" C) Walk away without saying anything.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A (friends do not need passwords).

E6. Mateo's grown-up says a good passphrase is...

A) Long, silly, and secret. B) Short and easy to type. C) The title of your favorite song.

Best: A. OK: C (better than "password" but easy to guess). **Oops-path: B.**

Zone 3: Fishy Pond (Peeper)

E7. A pop-up shows a shiny gold box and says "TAP THE BOX FOR YOUR PRIZE!"

A) Tap it. B) Pause, use SPOT (Secret? Pressure? Offer too good? Trick?), and tell a grown-up. C) Close it and keep playing, but tell nobody.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

E8. Sam gets a message: "Free game coins if you keep this a secret!"

A) Forward it to friends so they can have coins. B) Hackles up! "S for Secret." Tell a trusted adult. C) Close it and keep playing.

Best: B. OK: C (safe, but a grown-up could help and report it; tell next time). **Oops-path: A** (sharing a trick spreads it).

E9. Priya's friend sends a link with no words.

A) Pause. Check with her friend in person. B) Click it right away. C) Ignore it and keep playing.

Best: A. OK: C (safe, but her friend may need help if the account was taken over). **Oops-path: B.**

Zone 4: Share Meadow (Pip)

E10. A game asks for your full name and school for a leaderboard.

A) Type everything. B) Pick a silly leaderboard name instead. C) Pause and ask a grown-up what to use.

Best: C (then pick a silly name together). **OK: B. Oops-path: A.**

E11. Pip wants to post a photo of a birthday party where the house number is visible on the door.

A) Ask a grown-up first, and post it as it is if they say OK. B) Ask a grown-up first, and crop out the house number if you share it. C) Post it.

Best: B. OK: A (asking first is great; Pip would still crop the number).

Oops-path: C (once something is posted, it can travel, and "delete later" does not catch every copy).

E12. Kenji wants to share a funny group photo.

A) Ask everyone in the photo (and a grown-up) first. B) Ask a grown-up first, but do not ask your friends. C) Post it.

Best: A. OK: B (a grown-up helps, but friends get a say in their own pictures). **Oops-path: C.**

Zone 5: Friend Forest (Buddy)

E13. An online player says, "You're so good! Add me! I'm 10 too!"

A) Ignore it and say nothing to anyone. B) Say yes. C) Pause and ask a grown-up.

Best: C. OK: A (safe, but a grown-up can help). **Oops-path: B** (say yes only after a grown-up checks).

E14. A player says, "Want to talk in a private chat?"

A) Block them and not tell. B) Say OK. C) Say "No thanks" and tell a grown-up.

Best: C. OK: A. Oops-path: B.

E15. Amara's online teammate says, "Let's keep this chat a secret from your grown-ups."

A) Say "Secrets from grown-ups give me hackles up!" and tell a trusted grown-up. B) Keep it. C) Block them and not tell anyone.

Best: A. OK: C. Oops-path: B.

Zone 6: Kind Cove (Ember)

E16. Someone posts a silly picture of a classmate in the class chat.

A) Ignore it and scroll on. B) Laugh and share it. C) Do not share it. Tell a trusted adult, and be kind to the classmate.

Best: C. OK: A (not sharing is good; telling would help your classmate).

Oops-path: B (a joke can hurt).

E17. Dev feels sad after a mean comment in a game.

A) Be mean back. B) Hide it. C) Tell a trusted grown-up.

Best: C. OK: B. Oops-path: A.

E18. Ember says you have played for two hours.

A) Take a screen break: stretch, drink water, look out of a window. B) One more level. C) Keep playing.

Best: A. OK: B. Oops-path: C.

Zone 7: Fix-It Bridge (Fixit)

E19. Lily clicked a link by mistake.

A) Hide it. B) Oops! Tell a grown-up. No blame, just fix it. C) Close the page and tell a grown-up later.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

E20. Omar shared his password with a friend and feels bad.

A) Tell Teta and change the password. B) Hope nothing happens. C) Tell the friend to forget it.

Best: A. OK: C. Oops-path: B.

E21. Mateo told a friend about a problem and the friend said, "Ignore it." (Next-Rung Rule.)

A) Stop. B) Tell a trusted adult. C) Report the account without telling anyone.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

Zone 8: Hackles Peak (all)

E22. Which message makes your hackles go up?

A) Teacher: "Story time is at 2." B) Grandma's cat photo. C) A prize that needs a secret.

Best: C. OK: none; A and B are real. If a team shows A or B, say "that is a REAL one! A false alarm is fine, but let's check what had our hackles up about C."

E23. Put the steps in order.

A) Pause, Tell, Check. B) Hackles up, Pause, Check, Tell. C) Tap, Tell, Pause.

Best: B. OK: A. Oops-path: C.

E24. A grown-up got tricked and feels embarrassed. What do you say?

A) Tease them. B) "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault. Let's fix it." C) Say nothing.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

K-2 subset (12 cards, read aloud with hand-signal choices): E1, E2, E3, E5, E7, E10, E13, E14, E16, E18, E19, E22.

7B. 6-12 EVENT CARDS (24: 3 PER ZONE)

Settings are plain and respectful. No mascot dialogue. (H) = Heavy card, remove for opted-out classes. F13 and F14 touch on secrecy and manipulation patterns: read them first and skip them if your class is not ready.

Zone 1: Home Hollow (noticing the signal)

F1. A friend's account DMs you: "omg is this you in this video??? pixelclip.example/watch." Your hackles go up.

A) Pause. Check: ask the friend in person or by another way. B) Ignore it. C) Open it to see.

Best: A (Pause, second channel). **OK: B** (safe but the friend might be hacked and need to know). **Oops-path: C.**

F2. A classmate says, "Can you do me a favor and not tell your parents?"

A) Say yes. B) Hackles up. "Secret" is a flag. Ask what the favor is, and say you won't promise secrecy. C) Say nothing.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

F3. You feel a weird "off" feeling about a message but cannot say why.

A) Name the feeling ("Why are my hackles up?"), look for FLAGS, and tell someone. B) Dismiss it. C) Reply to ask who they are.

Best: A. OK: B. Oops-path: C.

Zone 2: Password Pines (Lock It)

F4. You reuse the same password on three accounts. One site announces a data breach.

A) Change only the breached account. B) Change that password everywhere, make each unique (use a password manager if you can), turn on 2-step verification. C) Do nothing.

Best: B. OK: A. Oops-path: C.

F5. A text arrives: "Hi, I sent my code to you by mistake. Can you read it back?"

A) Do not share it. A code is a key. B) Ask who it is. C) Read it.

Best: A. OK: B. Oops-path: C.

F6. Your phone offers to set up a passkey for an account.

A) Say yes after confirming it came from your own device and the real app. B) Say no, too complicated. C) Ignore it.

Best: A [VERIFY current passkey support and wording]. **OK: C.**

Oops-path: B (it is not scary; ask a trusted adult to help).

Zone 3: Fishy Pond (Spot It)

F7. A text: "Package undeliverable. Pay a \$1.99 redelivery fee at track-parcel.example/pay."

A) Delete it and move on. B) Pay. C) Do not tap. Open the store's own app to check the order.

Best: C. OK: A. Oops-path: B.

F8. A DM says: "You won a \$100 gift card! Confirm your username and password at claim-gift.example."

A) Name flags **Amazing offer** and **Login ask**. Report and delete. B) Confirm. C) Forward it to friends.

Best: A. OK: none. Oops-path: B and C.

F9. A text: "Hi, it's Coach. New number. Can you buy 4 gift cards for the team?"

A) Delete it and say nothing. B) Buy them. C) Do not reply. Call Coach on the number you already have.

Best: C. OK: A. Oops-path: B.

Zone 4: Share Meadow (Share Smart)

F10. An app asks for your contacts and microphone "to work properly."

A) Allow only what is needed, and say "Not now" to the rest. B) Skip the app. C) Allow all.

Best: A. OK: B. Oops-path: C.

F11. A group story shows a map dot at your house in real time.

A) Delete the app. B) Turn off precise location sharing for that app and check who can see it. C) Leave it.

Best: B. OK: A. Oops-path: C.

F12. A photo you want to post shows your school logo on your shirt and a street sign behind you.

A) Post but make it private. B) Post it. C) Crop or choose another photo.

Best: C. OK: A (private is better, but check who your followers are).

Oops-path: B.

Zone 5: Friend Forest (Safe People)

F13. An online friend says, "Let's switch to a private app. Don't tell your parents." (Pressure and secrecy pattern.)

A) Switch. B) Stop replying and block them, but tell nobody. C) Do not switch. Save the messages. Tell a trusted adult.

Best: C (STOP, SAVE, TELL). OK: B. Oops-path: A.

F14 (H). A teammate keeps giving you gifts and telling you that you are "more mature" than others.

A) Block and tell nobody. B) Accept and keep the secret. C) Recognize the pattern (trust, secrecy, isolation, escalation), stop replying, and tell a trusted adult.

Best: C. OK: A. Oops-path: B.

F15. A stranger sends you in-game items "just because."

A) Ignore without a word. B) Accept all. C) Pause. Ask what they want. Tell a trusted adult.

Best: C. OK: A. Oops-path: B.

Zone 6: Kind Cove (Kind and Well)

F16. A rumor is spreading in a group chat about a classmate.

A) Forward it. B) Leave the chat. C) Do not pass it on. Say something kind, or tell a trusted adult. Keep a screenshot of the words and link.

Best: C (an Upstander move). OK: B. Oops-path: A.

F17 (H). An anonymous post shows a classmate's photo with a mean caption.

A) Comment "lol." B) Do not share it. SAVE the link. TELL. REPORT. C) Share it.

Best: B. OK: none. Oops-path: C and A.

F18. You have kept a 100-day streak but you are tired and your homework is not done.

A) Notice the pull. Choose your own limit. Skip tonight. B) Ask the group to hold your streak. C) Keep the streak.

Best: A. OK: B. Oops-path: C.

Zone 7: Fix-It Bridge (Fix It)

F19. You clicked a link and typed your password.

A) Hope it is fine. B) Oops path: tell an adult, change the password, turn on 2-step, watch for odd messages. C) Change the password and stop there.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

F20. You think your account was taken over.

A) Make a new account. B) Use the app's recovery steps, change passwords, tell an adult and report. C) Use the same password and hope.

Best: B. OK: A. Oops-path: C.

F21. You told a friend about a problem and they said "don't tell anyone." (Next-Rung Rule.)

A) Tell another friend. B) Tell a trusted adult. C) Stop.

Best: B. OK: A. Oops-path: C.

Zone 8: Hackles Peak (all)

F22. A video shows your teacher announcing a snow day. It sounds right.

A) Share it. B) Check the school's official channel. Do not share until confirmed. C) Ignore it.

Best: B. OK: C. Oops-path: A.

F23 (H). A message says: "I will post your private chats unless you send me \$30 in gift cards. You have 1 hour."

A) STOP (do not pay, do not reply), SAVE (words, links), TELL a trusted adult, REPORT. B) Delete the chat. C) Pay.

Best: A. OK: none. Oops-path: C and B (deleting evidence makes it harder to help). It is never your fault.

F24. The Peak: pick one of these for your own Defense Plan.

A) Turn on 2-step verification on one account. B) Know one person you will tell and one sentence to say. C) Both.

Best: C. OK: A or B. Oops-path: none. Say them out loud to a partner.

8 Gifty Lure cards

The Reader says each lure and the whole class resists with the **Pause Palm**, names the flag, and then the Reader flips the **Gifty Coin** (see Rules). Nobody is ever asked to "tap".

8A. K-5 LURES (8)

#	GIFTY SAYS	RESIST MOVE	GIFTY'S LINE WHEN BEATEN
L1	"Psst! I have a SHINY prize just for YOU. It's free! You just tap, and don't tell anyone!"	Pause Palm. "Hackles up! S for Secret!"	"Drat! My secret-prize trick!"
L2	"I'm giving away 10,000 coins! Only 3 seconds left! 3... 2... 2 and a half..."	Pause for 10 seconds. "P for Pressure!"	"Nobody can count that slowly. I fell asleep."
L3	"Tell me your password and I will make you king of all the coins!"	"Passwords are for me and my grown-up."	"King of what, though? I didn't plan that."
L4	"Tell me where you live and I'll send you a pony!"	"Never tell private info." Tell a grown-up.	"Ponies don't fit in the mail, do they."
L5	"Beep boop. I am a VERY official pop-up. Your tablet has 47 problems! Tap here!"	Pause. "T for Trick!"	"I only know the number 47. It's my favorite."
L6	"This link is from your friend. (It is from me. I am wearing a friend hat.)"	"Check with my real friend."	"The hat was not a good disguise."
L7	"Everybody wins! Just type your name, school and birthday!"	"O for Offer too good."	"Everybody wins... a hook."
L8	"Don't tell your grown-up! They'll want a share of the prize!"	"Tell! Secrets are a Hackles up."	"Grown-ups have really good radar."

8B. 6-12 "TODAY'S TOO-GOOD OFFER" (8)

#	OFFER CARD (READ ALOUD)	FLAGS TO NAME	SECOND CHANNEL TO RESIST
G1	"Congratulations! You are today's winner. Confirm your login to claim."	A amazing, L ogin ask	Open the official app yourself; ask in person.
G2	"Your account will be suspended in 2 hours. Verify now."	F ast, L ogin ask	Check inside the app; do not use the message's link.
G3	"Special price for you only. Pay with gift cards. Don't tell anyone."	A amazing, G otta keep it secret	Official store; ask a trusted adult.
G4	"Join our private group. We will help you earn fast."	A amazing, G otta keep it secret	Ask what exactly, from whom; look for independent reviews.
G5	"Your friend sent you a gift. Open to claim."	S trange link	Message the friend in person.
G6	"You've been pre-approved for a free trial. Just a quick card number."	A amazing, L ogin/payment ask	Read terms; ask a trusted adult.
G7	"A video of you is going viral. See it here."	F ast, S trange link (shock bait)	Do not tap. Ask a trusted adult; check from your own account.
G8	"Download this free tool to see who views your profile."	A amazing, S trange link	App stores' official listing; see permissions.

Class response: hold the **Pause Palm**; name two flags; name the second channel. **If the class cannot name a channel, the Reader supplies one** and the class repeats it. This is a learning moment, not a loss.

9 Ladder Scenario cards (the L spaces)

Each card: **Scenario. First rung.** The class must climb to the **Next Rung** and say a sentence. This is where kids practice the Next-Rung Rule out loud.

9A. K-5 LADDER CARDS (8)

#	SCENARIO	FIRST RUNG RESULT	NEXT RUNG AND SENTENCE
LA1	Kenji sees a pop-up that says "Click to win!"	He tells a friend. The friend says, "Ignore it."	Rung 3: tell a trusted adult. "I need help with something online."
LA2	Maya clicked a game link by mistake.	Her older cousin is busy and says "later."	Rung 3: tell Dad. "Something happened and I'm not sure what to do."
LA3	Omar got a message asking for his password.	He tells a friend, who says "just tell them."	Rung 3: tell a trusted adult. "I'm not in trouble. I just need to tell you something."
LA4	Lily got a strange chat message.	She told Rosa. Rosa says "let's find Mom."	Rung 3: tell Mom. Good Reply: "Thank you for telling me. It is not your fault."
LA5	Dev has a mean comment in a game.	He told a teammate who shrugged.	Rung 3: tell the coach or the counselor.
LA6	Priya found a scam link.	She told her teacher. The teacher says "I will look later."	Keep climbing: tell another trusted adult; ask the counselor. "I need help right now."
LA7	Amara's game chat friend asks her to keep a secret.	She told a friend who said "keep it."	Rung 3: tell a trusted adult. "I'm not sure this secret is OK."
LA8	Sam thinks a friend's account was hacked.	The friend says "no way."	Rung 3 and 4: tell a trusted adult. The grown-up helps use the report tool.

9B. 6-12 LADDER CARDS (8)

#	SCENARIO	FIRST RUNG RESULT	NEXT RUNG AND SENTENCE
LB1	Jordan gets a pressuring message from someone online.	A friend says "just ignore it."	Rung 3: a trusted adult. "Something is going on and I need help figuring out what to do. Can I show you?"
LB2	A student sees a cruel rumor in a group chat.	A friend says "it's not our business."	Rung 3 and 4: tell a trusted adult and use the report tool. SAVE words and links.
LB3	You clicked a phishing link and typed a password.	You tell a sibling; they say "just change it."	Rung 3: tell a trusted adult and do the Oops path.
LB4	A friend posts something that worries you about their safety.	The friend says "I'm fine, don't tell."	Rung 3: tell a counselor or trusted adult. Mention it kindly. You can be worried and loyal.
LB5	You tell a teacher about a problem and they say they are too busy.	The teacher says "talk to me later."	The Next-Rung Rule: ask another adult or the counselor; write the problem down; "This is important to me."
LB6	You forwarded a fake video before checking.	You tell a friend who says "everyone did."	Rung 3: tell a trusted adult. Correct it: post a correction to the group.
LB7 (H)	Someone threatens to leak a private chat unless you pay.	You tell a friend. They say "pay it, it'll end."	STOP, SAVE, TELL a trusted adult, REPORT. Do not pay. It is never your fault.
LB8	You are asked to help a younger friend who is scared.	You say "talk to someone."	Be the helper: "Will you come with me while I tell someone?"

10 Helper cards (the H spaces, 10 cards)

#	HELPER	EFFECT
H1	Latch's Lock	Block one Glitter Slip this game (no pom-pom, no Detour).
H2	Peeper's Peek	On the next Event, the Reader removes one Oops-path choice before the team answers.
H3	Pip's Shell	The next G space is skipped (no Gifty turn).
H4	Buddy's Trusted Hand	Gain 1 Rung Token. Name a trusted adult at your school (no names needed; say the role).
H5	Ember's Warm Words	The next team moves +1. The team that draws this says one kind thing about another team's effort.
H6	Fixit's Toolbelt	Undo one Detour.
H7	Hackle's Quills	Take 1 pom-pom out of the Glitter Jar. Everyone does Hackles Up.
H8	Wild Pause	Everyone does three slow breaths. Take 1 pom-pom out of the Glitter Jar.
H9	Pass-It-On	Add 1 Rung Token to the class basket and say thank you to a team that helped someone.
H10	Ask Buddy	The Reader reads the "Best" answer's first clue before the team answers.

11 Fixit cards ("Oops Is Okay", 8 cards)

Draw one whenever a team chose an Oops-path answer, or whenever a Glitter Slip happens. Read it aloud. No one is in trouble: even when everyone does everything right, a trick can slip through.

#	FIXIT SAYS
X1	"Oops! Everyone clicks the wrong thing sometimes, even grown-ups. What would you do next time?"
X2	"I once wore two left shoes to a parade. We all learn. Today you learned a clue. High five!"
X3	"A mistake is just a fix waiting to happen. Who would you tell?"
X4	"Name one clue you will notice next time. (Pick from SPOT or FLAGS.)"
X5	"Tell your neighbor one thing you did right on this card."
X6	"Say the Tell sentence out loud to a partner: 'I need help with something online.'"
X7	"The Crew gets 1 Rung Token! Fixit pays you for being brave."
X8	"Everyone does the Tell Wave. Telling is the strongest move in the whole game."

12 Variants for each grade band

K-2 "TRAIL WALK" (AGES 5-7)

- **Floor board:** tape 20 spaces on the floor in a winding line (use 5 zones: Home Hollow, Password Pines, Fishy Pond, Share Meadow, Fix-It Bridge) with colored paper plates **that also carry a picture** (a lock, a magnifier, a shell, a bridge). One child per turn is **Hackle's Walker** and carries the Crew Token plush. Walkers always get a turn; rotate gently, with passing allowed. Children who cannot walk the path can send the plush with a "Walker's Helper" or move it on a tabletop copy.
- **Cards:** use the K-2 subset (12 Events). The teacher reads the situation and the three choices *with hand signals* (A = Hackles Up, B = Pause Palm, C = Tell Wave) or pictures on paper. Everyone answers with the signal at the same moment.
- **No counting:** the Walker always takes **3 steps**, whatever the answer. The teacher never says "wrong". If the answer was the Oops-path, the teacher says "Let's ask Fixit," and the class does the Tell Wave.
- **Gifty:** a puppet or a cardboard box with a ribbon. Gifty only asks silly things. The class answers "Pause Palm!" in unison. The teacher says "Gifty never wins!" **K-2 has no Detours and no Glitter Slips:** every Gifty turn is a cheer.
- **Glitter Jar:** skip it for K-2 (no Storm). Add a pom-pom to a "Hackles Jar" for every cheer, and shake it at the Peak.
- **Ladder:** use the **Trusted Hand:** up to five fingers, five trusted grown-ups.
- **Time:** 20 spaces at 3 steps is about 7 turns, about 10 minutes. Two sessions of Mini Trail make a 30-minute lesson.
- **Lessons:** L1, L2, L3, L4.

3-5 "HANDS-ON HACKERS TRAIL" (AGES 8-10)

- Full rules. Teams pick Crew names from the Hands-On Hackers characters (Mateo's Codebreakers, Amara's Gamers, Priya's Detectives, Kenji's Tellers, Sam's Artists).
- **Bonus clue:** if the active team names the SPOT letter on a Fishy Pond event, the Crew takes +1 step.

- **Role cards:** Reader, Navigator (moves token), Reporter (announces), Timekeeper. Rotate every few turns so every child gets a job.
- **Lessons:** L1, L2, L3, L6, L10.

6-8 "CASE FILE TRAIL" (AGES 11-13)

- Use the 6-12 Event cards; remove (H) cards if needed.
- **Name the rung and the signal:** every answer must include "Hackles up? because ..." and "I would tell ..." to earn a Best.
- **Double Check rule:** for every Best answer, the team must name a second channel.
- **Evidence tokens:** a class "Evidence Folder" collects SAVE details (what to save: words, links, usernames, dates, but not private images). Teams add a note on a sticky.
- **Lessons:** L1, L2, L3, L7 (with H cards), L9.

9-12 "TRAIL BRIEFING" (AGES 14-18)

- Use the 6-12 Events. Before choosing A, B or C, teams must **debate for 45 seconds:** "What is the risk? Who benefits? Which answer is easy to do at 1 a.m.?"
- **Defense Budget:** each team has 3 "Effort Chips" to spend on any Event for a bonus move. Learn that defense has costs and benefits; the best protection is often cheap (2-step, a code word, a person to tell).
- **Peak Capstone:** at Hackles Peak each team writes one line of their personal **Defense Plan** (Lesson 10): "I will turn on 2-step on _____. My person to tell is _____. My sentence is _____." (They keep it private.)
- **Lessons:** L1, L2, L3, L8, L10.

13 Teacher notes

WHY A TRICKSTER?

Kids love a villain who loses. A silly trickster means that threats feel manageable and funny, and the protagonist is always the class. But never make Gifty a *person*: do not dress as a stranger, do not role-play "the person who tricks you". Gifty is a box with a hook. A funny box is a safe way to rehearse a scary-adjacent skill.

COMMON STUDENT REACTIONS

- **"I want to be Gifty!"** Offer a "Gifty Voice Contest" at recess: students invent *silly offers a box might make* (e.g., "Free socks! They are lonely!"), but they never write or practice real tricks or ask real questions. Keep it absurd.
- **"This is too easy."** Move to the next band's cards or add the debate rule.
- **"Is it okay to say the wrong thing?"** Yes. An Oops-path answer still moves you forward and brings a Fixit gift.

CAUTIONS

- Do not use real students' accounts, names, or incidents as event cards.
- Remove (H) cards and L7/L8 events if families opted out of sensitive lessons.
- If a student seems triggered (shaky voice, wants to leave), allow a Pass, use the quiet corner, and follow the disclosure box in your guide.
- Always end on the Big Pause so the group returns to calm.

DEBRIEF QUESTIONS (3 MINUTES)

1. Which event was the trickiest? What made you hesitate?
2. What was your favorite Pause? What was your favorite Tell?
3. Name one flag that Gifty uses a lot.
4. Who is one trusted adult you could tell? What is one sentence you would say? (Say it to your neighbor.)

14 Accessibility variants

NEED	WHAT TO DO
Color-vision difference	Zones are named and carry a picture and a symbol, not just a color. Answer cards are circle / triangle / square with big letters and different notched corners. Pass cards say PASS and have a check mark. The Glitter Jar and Gifty Coin are told apart by shape and word.
Low vision / blind	Floor-tape board with textured tape for zones; a plush or heavy Crew Token you can feel; large print cards (at least 24 pt); read every card twice. The coin has a raised hook side (a dab of glue) so it can be felt.
Deaf or hard of hearing	Show every card on a screen or hold it up; point to the text as you read. A visual 20-second timer. "Peek!" is a raised hand. Gifty's voice is also shown as a printed speech bubble.
Dyslexia / reading difficulty	The Reader reads aloud twice; A/B/C answers by card or signal; pictures on Lure and Ladder cards. Never ask a child to read in front of the class.
English language learners	A helper repeats the card in the home language; answers by card or signal; allow a team to discuss in any language. Gifty's catchphrases are chants, so repeat them together.
Motor / mobility	36-inch (about 90 cm) paths if the board is on the floor; a tabletop copy; a helper moves the token for any child. Answer cards on a stand or velcro.
Sensory / noise	Whisper huddles; waving hands instead of cheers; Gifty's voice kept gentle; a quiet corner and Pass cards. The Sparkle Storm can be done silently (jazz hands only).
Anxiety about being wrong or being the center	Every team answers every card; the active team decides but can say "Pass to the Guides"; the Oops-path is read as a story, not a grade; the coin flip (not a person) causes any slip.
K-2 / developmental differences	Use the Trail Walk variant: no counting, no Detours, signals instead of letters.

15 Printables checklist (print and cut exactly this)

Art for all items comes from the art team. Reference these files in [kit/09_Art/characters/](#) (do not edit them).

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
1	Board	4 poster sheets taped (or floor tape) with 40 spaces in 8 zones; mark spaces 1 and 2 as the doorstep	Tape; draw the 40 circles with the E/L/H/B/G codes from Section 2.1	Zone art: hackle_happy.png (Home Hollow), latch.png (Password Pines), peeper.png (Fishy Pond), pip.png (Share Meadow), buddy.png (Friend Forest), kindle.png (Kind Cove), fixit.png (Fix-It Bridge), hackle_proud.png (Hackles Peak flag)
2	Trail Event cards	24 for your band (K-5: E1-E24; 6-12: F1-F24). K-2: the 12 subset cards.	Cut 24 cards; front = situation + A/B/C, back = Best / OK / Oops-path	hackle_curious.png corner icon on K-5 cards; no mascot on 6-12 cards
3	Gifty Lure cards	8 for your band (L1-L8 or G1-G8)	Cut 8	[ART REQUEST: Gifty art is not yet in characters/; ask the art team for gifty.png]

#	PRINT	HOW MANY	CUT / ASSEMBLE	ART TO USE
4	Ladder Scenario cards	8 for your band (LAI-LA8 or LBI-LB8)	Cut 8	buddy.png
5	Helper cards	10 (HI-HI0)	Cut 10	Crew art on each: latch.png, peeper.png, pip.png, buddy.png, kindle.png, fixit.png, hackle_up.png
6	Fixit cards	8 (XI-X8)	Cut 8	fixit.png
7	Answer cards	3 per team x 6 = 18 (6 circle A, 6 triangle B, 6 square C), different notched corners	Cut shapes	none
8	Pass cards	1 per child (30), green, PASS plus check mark	Cut	buddy.png
9	Team tent cards	6	Fold	crew_group.png
10	Class Ladder strip	1 (3 climbing rungs + ground), Glitter Jar label (1) and Gift Coin (1 paper disc, front hook, back star)	Cut and tape	fixit.png on the ladder
11	Rung Tokens	10 craft sticks or paper rungs	Cut	none
12	Crew Token	1	Cut, glue to a clothespin	hackle_curious.png
13	Certificates "Hackles Trail Crew"	1 per child	Fill in	hackle_proud.png
14	Teacher Quick Start page	1	Keep with the cards	none

Cut list total for one band (Full Trail): 24 Events + 8 Lures + 8 Ladder + 10 Helpers + 8 Fixit = **58 cards**, plus 18 answer cards, 30 Pass cards, 6 tent cards, 10 Rung Tokens, 1 token, 1 coin, 1 ladder strip.